

THE INTERN VOICE

A clean editorial interview series
Women, internships and career confidence

INTERVIEWEE A - JOURNALISM STUDENT

SARAH LIM



INTERVIEWEE A - JOURNALISM STUDENT

From Silence to a Byline

Sarah Lim - Final-year Mass Communication student

Sarah's internship began with fear and quiet observation. By the end, she had interviewed strangers, written published stories and learned that her voice could belong in a newsroom.



AGE	PROGRAMME	INTERNSHIP	THEME
22	Bachelor of Mass Communication	Local online news portal	From shy student to young reporter

FEATURE CONTEXT Sarah completed a three-month internship as a newsroom intern during the final year of her journalism programme. She assisted reporters with interviews, news writing, photography and social media updates. WHY IT MATTERS Sarah's story gives the project its emotional starting point. Her growth was not dramatic in a cinematic way; it happened through ordinary newsroom routines, repeated practice and small assignments that gradually became more serious.	SELECTED INTERVIEW Q A Could you please introduce yourself? My name is Sarah Lim, and I am a final-year Mass Communication student majoring in Journalism. I completed a three-month internship at... Q A How did you overcome those challenges? My editor was very patient. She encouraged me to prepare well before every interview and reminded me that mistakes are part of...	STORY ARC FIRST DAY Stayed quiet during editorial discussions and doubted whether her ideas were useful. FIRST ASSIGNMENT Prepared carefully, interviewed sources and began to trust the reporting process. PUBLISHED STORY Saw her byline online and started to view herself as a young journalist.												
TURNING POINT Q A Can you remember a moment that made you feel proud of yourself? About two months into my internship, my editor asked me to cover a community event by myself. I interviewed several people, took photographs, wrote... Q A Besides journalism skills, what did you learn from the internship? I learned how to communicate with different people and how to stay calm under pressure. Newsrooms are fast-paced, so I had to organise my time...	MINI FEATURE NOTE For a journalism student, confidence is not separate from professional skill. The ability to ask questions, listen carefully and write under pressure depends on believing that one's presence in the room is valid. GROWTH POINT Sarah completed an independent assignment and saw her first byline published online.	KEY FINDINGS Sarah's interview shows that confidence develops gradually through practical workplace experience rather than classroom learning alone. Mentorship played a major role in her growth. Constructive guidance from her editor helped Sarah view mistakes as learning opportunities instead of failures.												
		SKILLS MAP <table><tr><td>Interviewing</td><td> </td><td>88%</td></tr><tr><td>Writing</td><td> </td><td>82%</td></tr><tr><td>Confidence</td><td> </td><td>84%</td></tr><tr><td>Deadline Focus</td><td> </td><td>78%</td></tr></table>	Interviewing		88%	Writing		82%	Confidence		84%	Deadline Focus		78%
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EDITORIAL SNAPSHOT		
CHALLENGE Fear of interviewing strangers and speaking during editorial meetings.	SUPPORT A patient editor encouraged preparation, practice and learning from mistakes.	GROWTH Sarah completed an independent assignment and saw her first byline published online.

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INTERVIEWEE B - BUSINESS STUDENT

AISYAH RAHMAN

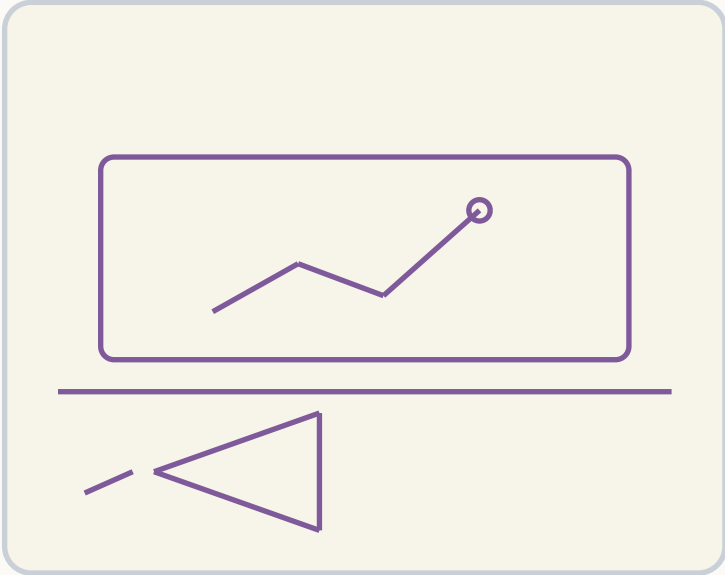


INTERVIEWEE B - BUSINESS STUDENT

Learning Resilience Under Pressure

Aisyah Rahman - Final-year Business Administration student

Aisyah entered marketing expecting to observe from the side. Instead, supplier calls, campaign reports and team presentations pushed her to become more independent.



AGE	PROGRAMME	INTERNSHIP	THEME
23	Bachelor of Business Administration	Retail marketing department	Resilience in a fast-paced workplace

FEATURE CONTEXT

Aisyah completed a four-month internship in the marketing department of a consumer goods company. Her responsibilities included promotional campaign support, marketing reports, supplier communication and social media activities.

WHY IT MATTERS

Her story shows another side of empowerment: the ability to stay calm when work moves quickly. In a business environment, confidence often grows from preparation, responsibility and repeated communication.

SELECTED INTERVIEW

Q

A

Could you introduce yourself?
My name is Aisyah Rahman. I am a final-year Business Administration student. I completed a four-month internship in the marketing...

Q

A

What was your biggest challenge?
During my second month, my supervisor asked me to coordinate with several suppliers for a promotional campaign. I had never...

STORY ARC

●

EXPECTATION
Expected simple observation and light administrative work.

●

PRESSURE POINT
Handled supplier communication for a promotional campaign.

●

GROWTH MOMENT
Presented a campaign report and became clearer about pursuing marketing.

TURNING POINT

Q

A

How did you deal with the situation?
I prepared carefully before every phone call and email. My supervisor reviewed my first few emails and explained how to communicate professionally...

Q

A

Was there a moment when you felt you had really grown?
Near the end of my internship, my supervisor asked me to present a campaign report during a team meeting. I was extremely nervous because everyone...

MINI FEATURE NOTE

Aisyah's experience also shows the value of a supervisor who does not remove every challenge, but teaches the intern how to approach it with clearer thinking.

GROWTH POINT

Aisyah presented a campaign report and became clearer about pursuing marketing.

KEY FINDINGS

Aisyah's interview highlights that confidence is closely connected to resilience and practical experience.

Supportive leadership helped her transform uncertainty into confidence by encouraging independent thinking rather than simply providing answers.

SKILLS MAP

Communication		86%
Problem Solving		82%
Adaptability		88%
Presentation		76%

EDITORIAL SNAPSHOT		
CHALLENGE Fast deadlines, supplier communication and fear of making professional mistakes.	SUPPORT A supervisor reviewed early emails and encouraged independent thinking.	GROWTH Aisyah presented a campaign report and became clearer about pursuing marketing.

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INTERVIEWEE C - RECENT GRADUATE

EMILY TAN

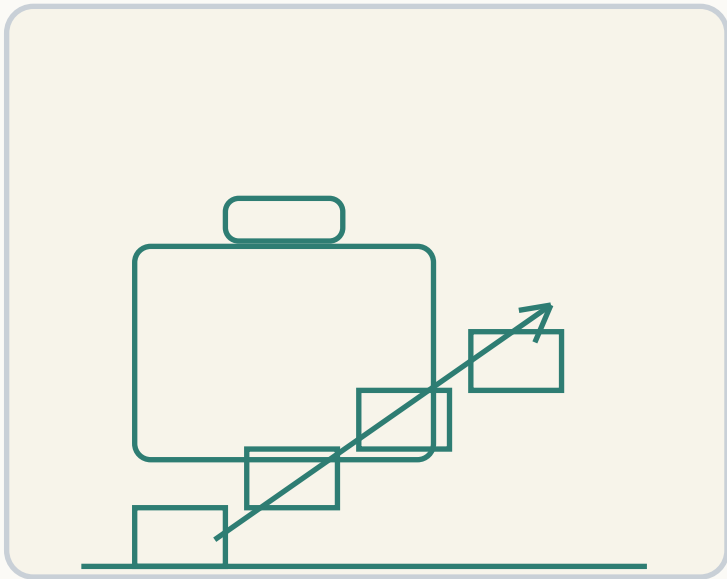


INTERVIEWEE C - RECENT GRADUATE

The Bridge From Campus to Career

Emily Tan - Marketing Executive and recent graduate

Emily's internship did not end when the placement finished. The confidence she gained followed her into her first full-time marketing role.



AGE

24

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Mass Communication

INTERNSHIP

Digital marketing agency

THEME

From internship to full-time work

FEATURE CONTEXT

Emily graduated one year ago and now works as a Marketing Executive at an advertising agency in Kuala Lumpur. She completed a four-month internship at a digital marketing agency before graduation.

WHY IT MATTERS

Emily provides a longer view of internship impact. As a recent graduate, she can compare university learning, internship training and the real demands of full-time employment.

SELECTED INTERVIEW

- Q

A

Could you introduce yourself?

My name is Emily Tan. I graduated last year with a degree in Mass Communication. I now work as a Marketing Executive in an advertising...
- Q

A

Was there a turning point?

One day my supervisor asked me to present a campaign proposal to a client because another colleague was unavailable. I was nervous...

STORY ARC

- BEFORE INTERNSHIP

Worried about whether she could meet professional expectations.
- CLIENT MOMENT

Presented a campaign proposal when a colleague was unavailable.
- AFTER GRADUATION

Entered full-time work with less fear and more workplace familiarity.

TURNING POINT

- Q

A

In what way did it change you?

Before that day, I thought confidence meant never feeling nervous. After the presentation, I realised confidence means doing your best even when you...
- Q

A

Did your internship help you after graduation?

Definitely. When I started my current job, many tasks already felt familiar. I understood workplace communication, knew how to manage deadlines and...

MINI FEATURE NOTE

Her reflection suggests that internships are not only about immediate learning outcomes. They can shape how graduates speak in meetings, manage deadlines and understand professional responsibility.

GROWTH POINT
Emily carried her internship confidence into her first full-time marketing role.

KEY FINDINGS

Emily's interview demonstrates the long-term value of internship experiences beyond graduation.

Meaningful responsibilities accelerated her personal growth. Being trusted to present ideas, communicate with clients and manage projects helped her recognise her own capabilities.

SKILLS MAP



EDITORIAL SNAPSHOT

CHALLENGE

Client presentations and the fear of not meeting professional expectations.

SUPPORT

Her supervisor encouraged questions and reminded her that interns are there to learn.

GROWTH

Emily carried her internship confidence into her first full-time marketing role.

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INTERVIEWEE D - MARKETING MANAGER

MICHELLE WONG

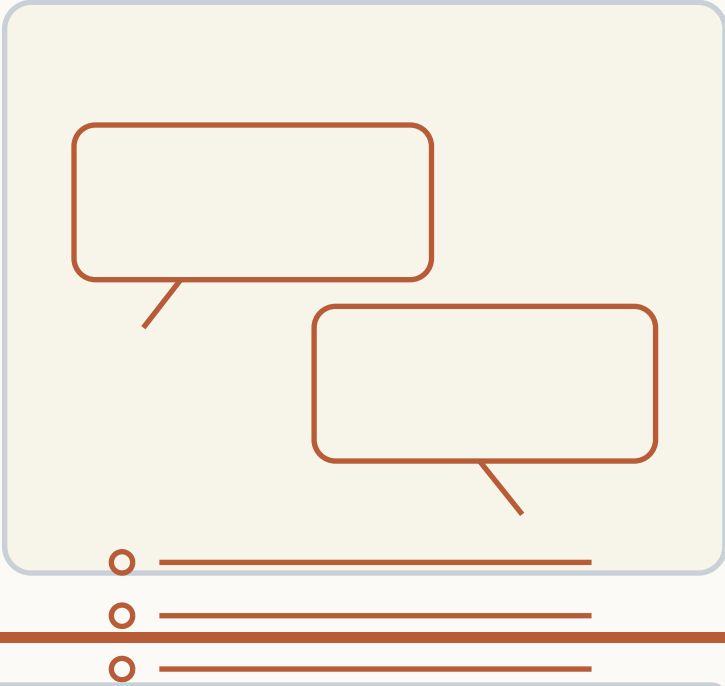


INTERVIEWEE D - MARKETING MANAGER

Mentorship as a Form of Empowerment

Michelle Wong - Marketing Manager and internship supervisor

Michelle sees interns from the other side of the desk. For her, meaningful work and patient guidance can turn quiet students into confident contributors.



AGE	INDUSTRY	EXPERIENCE	THEME
36	Digital marketing agency	12 years	Mentorship and workplace support

FEATURE CONTEXT

Michelle has worked in marketing for more than a decade and currently manages a team of executives and interns at a digital marketing agency in Kuala Lumpur.

WHY IT MATTERS

Michelle's interview shifts the story from student experience to workplace responsibility. Her perspective shows that empowerment is shaped by the environment an organisation creates.

SELECTED INTERVIEW

Q

A

Could you tell us about your role?

I am the Marketing Manager, and one of my responsibilities is supervising interns and junior staff. Every year, we work with students...

How do you help interns become more confident?

I try to involve them in real projects instead of giving them only administrative work. I encourage them to attend meetings, present...

STORY ARC

OBSERVATION

Noticed that many capable female interns underestimated themselves.

METHOD

Gave interns real projects, meeting exposure and feedback after each task.

OUTCOME

Saw quiet interns gradually become confident contributors.

TURNING POINT

Q

A

Can you remember a moment when you saw an intern grow?

One intern hardly spoke during her first month. She always stayed quiet in meetings. After several months, she volunteered to present part of a...

How important is mentorship during internships?

It is extremely important. A good mentor creates a safe environment where interns can ask questions and make mistakes. When students know they are...

MINI FEATURE NOTE

She argues that interns should not be treated as temporary assistants. When companies provide real tasks, client exposure and feedback, they help build the next generation of professionals.

GROWTH POINT

Michelle has seen quiet interns become confident contributors through guided experience.

KEY FINDINGS

Michelle's interview highlights the critical role of workplace mentorship in empowering female interns.

She believes that organisations should provide authentic learning experiences rather than limiting interns to routine administrative tasks.

SKILLS MAP

Mentorship		92%
Feedback		88%
Leadership		86%
Opportunity Design		84%

EDITORIAL SNAPSHOT		
CHALLENGE Many capable female interns underestimate themselves and stay quiet in meetings.	SUPPORT Meaningful projects, client exposure and constructive feedback help interns grow.	GROWTH Michelle has seen quiet interns become confident contributors through guided experience.

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INTERVIEWEE E - HUMAN RESOURCES EXECUTIVE

JESSICA LEE



INTERVIEWEE E - HUMAN RESOURCES EXECUTIVE

When Confidence Enters the Interview Room

Jessica Lee - Human Resources Executive

Jessica's HR perspective shows how meaningful internship experience becomes visible when graduates apply for jobs and speak about what they have done.



AGE	INDUSTRY	EXPERIENCE	THEME
34	Human resources and talent management	10 years	Recruitment and career readiness

FEATURE CONTEXT

Jessica has worked in Human Resources for more than ten years and is responsible for graduate recruitment, internship programmes, onboarding and talent development.

WHY IT MATTERS

Jessica completes the reporting chain by connecting internships to recruitment. Her comments show that employers notice when applicants can describe real responsibilities, teamwork and problem-solving.

SELECTED INTERVIEW

- Q

A

Could you briefly introduce your role?

I work as a Human Resources Executive. My main responsibilities include recruiting interns and full-time employees, conducting...
- Q

A

What challenges do female graduates commonly face?

Many female graduates are capable, but they sometimes underestimate themselves. During interviews, some hesitate to talk about their...

STORY ARC

- APPLICATION

Candidates with meaningful internships can describe real projects and challenges.
- INTERVIEW

Confidence becomes visible when graduates explain what they learned.
- CAREER READINESS

Workplace experience helps young women enter employment with stronger self-belief.

TURNING POINT

- Q

A

How can internships help young women overcome these challenges?

Internships allow students to experience real workplaces before graduation. They learn how to communicate professionally, solve problems and work...
- Q

A

What makes an intern stand out?

Initiative. We remember interns who ask thoughtful questions, volunteer for new tasks and actively look for ways to improve. Confidence is important...

MINI FEATURE NOTE

Her interview also highlights a recurring issue in the project: talented young women may downplay their achievements. Internship experience gives them concrete examples that help them speak with more confidence.

GROWTH POINT
Internship experience helps applicants explain real projects, teamwork and problem-solving.

KEY FINDINGS

Jessica's interview demonstrates that internship experiences influence employability beyond technical skills.

From a recruitment perspective, employers value communication, adaptability, initiative and confidence just as highly as academic qualifications.

SKILLS MAP

Recruitment Insight		90%
Communication		86%
Adaptability		82%
Initiative		88%

EDITORIAL SNAPSHOT

CHALLENGE	SUPPORT	GROWTH
Female graduates sometimes downplay their achievements during job interviews.	Clear feedback, equal opportunities and respectful onboarding build workplace confidence.	Internship experience helps applicants explain real projects, teamwork and problem-solving.